

I tried the game out. Here's my lists of pros and cons:

Pros:

- Interactive Fiction
- Reads like those text based adventures
- The people who initially seem to be ok with the environmental situation change their dialogue after you look into the matter
- The map/route options
- The animation's pretty good
- The way certain places will have new info after you check out more things
- The Journal. I love how it takes notes about what you've done so far.

Cons/What I would like to add:

- The journal repeats notes. It doesn't need to be anything complex, but right now it repeats stuff if you repeatedly check the same notes.
- Certain route options aren't always available unless you're at a neighboring route. That would be fine if there were some in-game explanation like a map or something that shows how you need to get there.
- Right now you're observing/asking questions. You can't really do anything activity wise. Some basic additions could include you picking up tools/evidence. Also the ability to click on things to take a closer look/pick something up would be cool
- Backstory for the protagonist would be interesting. I'm not asking for the story of their life but something fascinating that explains what they're doing here. They could be a student who is looking for an environmentally-focused paper/project, a freelance journalist, a researcher looking for an unusual situation, maybe even someone with personal connections to someone who lives/used to live in the area
- The Ecolens knowledge symbols are interesting but maybe we could make them a bit more distinct, like 15 Ecolens points or maybe it would be something that could be used to unlock new areas. Less numbers and more distinct symbol that goes 'you have a decent bit/amount of knowledge and can unlock something new.'
- Places that have already been fully (as of yet) explored still show the ecolens knowledge symbol as if you can gain more knowledge right away by clicking them. Perhaps we should only include ecolens symbol on places that have new/unread information and even

then perhaps only sometimes; sometimes half the fun is figuring out what you have and haven't explored in exploration games. Not grinding everything the user has already looked at, more like hints as opposed to obvious 'unread' signs unless this symbol could just be the tutorial symbol before the player gets into the thick of it and things turn gradually more difficult.

- Perhaps the journal could have a book-type aesthetic once we're able to do that. When the user has enough notes to fill multiple pages, it would be fun to click the corner of the page to turn it like a real explorer's book.
- More backstory would be interesting. Perhaps the lady worker's grandmother was a caretaker at one point, and you learn this throughout the game as you collect bits and pieces of information for the bigger picture.
- What is the big picture of the game? Is it the corporation's pollution in this specific area, or is this the first quest? Do we want to alert the user to what kind of scope the game will have early on in game?
- Just more story would be interesting. Should I help with the storywriting? I'm thinking for example that the worker man here could be one of those workers who's just trying to make a living but has mixed feelings on how he's doing it. Maybe he's a reluctant ally to them just by working for them but the player gets him to join them in exposing the company to the public in a way that makes them more personally invested. And the mushrooms, what's going on with that is their dealing with the chemicals a good thing but still a temporary and incomplete fix, or is it a whole 'radioactive fungi' pollution problem?
- Perhaps real life species/chemicals names to connect it to real life quite a bit more, it would make it feel less abstract of a problem. Like, oaks and certain types of mushrooms, and maybe the chemicals belong to a fast fashion industry that's popular in game, or medical runoff, or oil leaks from a popular gas company?